

BioTrajectoryAnalysis

User Manual Version 1.0

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1 Introduction

BioTrajectoryAnalysis is an open-source collection of Python tools for the extraction and quantitative analysis of biological trajectories from video recordings.

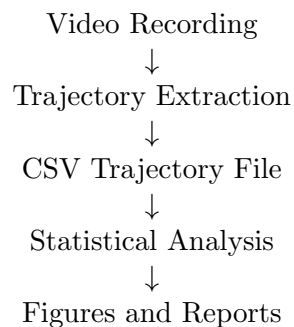
The software combines computer vision, automated tracking, and statistical-physics descriptors to characterize motion patterns in biological systems. The first module included in the project, **AntTrajectoryAnalysis**, was developed for the study of ant foraging trajectories, but the methodology can be extended to other organisms such as protozoa, rotifers, nematodes, and slugs.

The software consists of two main programs:

1. **AntTracking_V1.0.py** for trajectory extraction.
2. **AntTrajectoryAnalysis_V1.0.py** for statistical analysis.

2 Workflow

The typical workflow is:



3 Installation

The software requires:

- Python 3.10 or newer
- OpenCV
- NumPy
- Pandas
- SciPy

- Matplotlib
- scikit-learn

The required packages can be installed using:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

4 Trajectory Extraction

4.1 Overview

The program `AntTracking_V1.0.py` extracts trajectories from video recordings.

The program can:

- Select a region of interest (ROI)
- Detect moving organisms
- Filter detections by size and shape
- Reconstruct trajectories
- Convert pixel coordinates into physical units
- Save trajectory data

4.2 Basic Usage

```
python AntTracking_V1.0.py video.mov
```

4.3 Example

```
python AntTracking_V1.0.py video.mov
    --threshold 18
    --min-area 6
    --max-area 250
    --output tracking_results
```

4.4 Important Parameters

threshold Motion detection threshold.

min-area Minimum contour area accepted as a valid object.

max-area Maximum contour area accepted as a valid object.

max-distance Maximum distance used to associate detections between frames.

max-gap Maximum number of missing frames allowed before terminating a track.

merge-distance Distance used to merge nearby detections.

5 Output Files

Typical output includes:

- `ant_tracks.csv`
- `config.json`
- diagnostic images
- tracking statistics

6 Trajectory Analysis

6.1 Overview

The program `AntTrajectoryAnalysis_V1.0.py` computes statistical descriptors from the extracted trajectories.

The software performs:

- Convex hull analysis
- Monte Carlo area estimation
- Occupancy mapping
- Principal Component Analysis (PCA)
- Mean Squared Displacement (MSD)
- Straightness analysis
- Fractal dimension estimation

6.2 Basic Usage

```
python AntTrajectoryAnalysis_V1.0.py
    ant_tracks.csv
```

6.3 Example

```
python AntTrajectoryAnalysis_V1.0.py
    ant_tracks.csv
    --cm-per-pixel 0.02
    --output analysis_results
```

7 Generated Figures

The analysis program produces several publication-quality figures.

7.1 Spatial Exploration and Anisotropy

Shows:

- trajectory map
- convex hull
- PCA axes
- whitened coordinates

7.2 Occupancy Maps

Shows spatial utilization of the explored region.

7.3 Monte Carlo Area Estimation

Illustrates the Monte Carlo estimate of the explored area.

7.4 Trajectory Statistics

Includes:

- Mean Squared Displacement
- Straightness distributions
- Additional trajectory descriptors

8 Statistical Descriptors

8.1 Explored Area

Estimated using the convex hull of all recorded positions.

8.2 Occupancy Maps

Quantify how frequently different regions are visited.

8.3 Principal Component Analysis

Measures spatial anisotropy.

8.4 Mean Squared Displacement

Characterizes transport properties.

8.5 Straightness

Measures path tortuosity.

8.6 Fractal Dimension

Quantifies the complexity and space-filling properties of trajectories.

9 Applications

10 Worked Example

This section illustrates a complete analysis starting from a trajectory file generated by the tracking program.

10.1 Running the analysis

Run the tracking script using the given `config.json` file.

```
python3 ../tracking/AntTracking_V1.0.py SampleVideo.mov --config config.json --display --out
```



Figure 1: Tracking software interface. **Top:** Selection of the region of interest (ROI), indicated by the green rectangle. The ROI coordinates are stored in the `config.json` file and can be reused for subsequent analyses. **Bottom:** After confirming the ROI selection, the program begins the analysis. Moving ants are detected and tracked, and individual trajectories are displayed using different colours.

After tracking a video, the file `ant_tracks.csv` is saved in the output directory. The trajectory-analysis program can be run using:

```
python3 ../analysis/AntTrajectoryAnalysis_V1.0.py tracking_results/ant_tracks.csv
```

The program loads the trajectory file, identifies the coordinate units and track columns, computes the statistical descriptors, and generates figures and report files.

A typical output is:

```
ANT TRAJECTORY ANALYSIS
Spatial exploration | Monte Carlo area | PCA anisotropy | stochastic descriptors
=====
Loading: tracking_results/ant_tracks.csv
Loaded 23,708 positions
Coordinate unit: cm
cm_per_pixel: 0.027607362
ID column: track_id; frame column: frame
Generating figures...
```

10.2 Example analysis report

The program generates a text report summarizing the main descriptors. For example:

```
1. SPATIAL EXPLORATION AND MONTE CARLO AREA
Convex hull area: 454.3026 cm^2
Circularity index: 0.4188
Monte Carlo area: 453.3648 cm^2
Monte Carlo 95% CI: [452.3860, 454.3437] cm^2

2. PCA ANISOTROPY
Anisotropy ratio lambda1/lambda2: 32.2926
Principal orientation: 179.25 degrees
Explained variance PC1: 97.00%

3. STOCHASTIC TRAJECTORY DESCRIPTORS
MSD exponent beta: 1.3492
Mean straightness: 0.4245
Fractal dimension D: 1.6850
```

10.3 Generated output files

The analysis creates an output directory named `ant_trajectory-biophysics.analysis` containing:

- `analysis_report.txt`
- `analysis_results.json`
- `spatial_exploration_anisotropy.pdf`
- `density_heatmap.pdf`
- `trajectory_statistics.pdf`
- `monte_carlo_area.pdf`

10.4 Example figures

The generated figures summarize different aspects of the trajectory dataset.

Spatial Exploration and Anisotropy Analysis

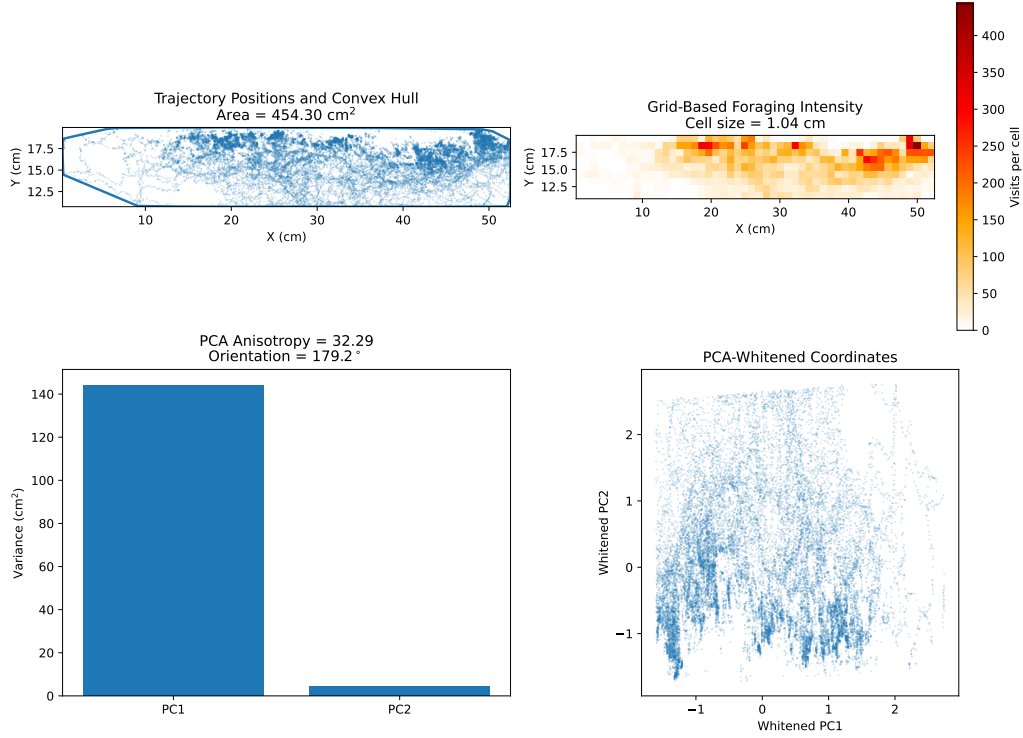


Figure 2: Example output showing tracked positions, convex hull, and PCA-based anisotropy analysis.

10.5 Interpretation

In this example, the trajectory distribution is strongly anisotropic, with an anisotropy ratio of approximately 32. The convex-hull and Monte Carlo area estimates are in close agreement, showing that the Monte Carlo method provides a reliable estimate of the explored spatial domain. The MSD exponent is larger than one, indicating superdiffusive motion, while the fractal dimension provides a measure of the space-filling character of the trajectories.

11 Citation

If you use this software in academic work, please cite the associated publication and the Bio-TrajectoryAnalysis repository.

12 License

This software is distributed under the MIT License.

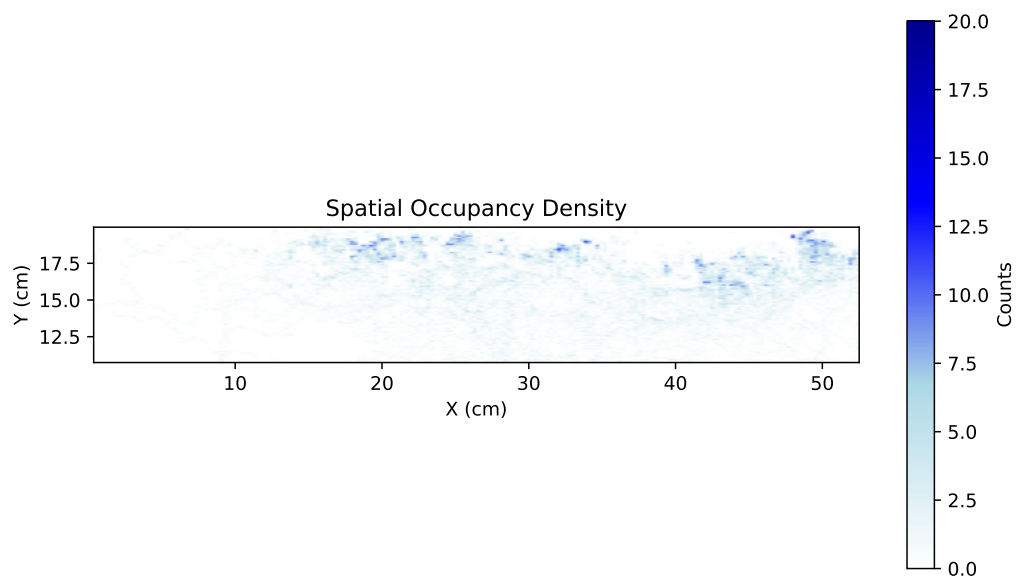


Figure 3: Example spatial occupancy map generated from the tracked ant positions.